



BEFORE

Since the advent of agriculture, people have lived in communities. The city has evolved as a center of commerce and power.



HERCULANEUM, ITALY

ANCIENT CITIES

Towns and cities emerged in Asia and Egypt in the 4th millennium BCE

◀ 44–45. Larger towns grew into **densely populated walled cities**, with streets running at right angles to each other, to form a grid pattern.

Ancient Greek ◀ 94–95 and Roman cities ◀ 110–13, like Herculaneum, became centers of intellectual, religious, and commercial life.

THE MEDIEVAL PERIOD

After the fall of the Roman Empire ◀ 150–51 western European cities declined. In the medieval period towns began to expand again, often around a castle or monastery ◀ 188–91.

REVIVAL OF CITY LIFE

Town planning was revived during the Renaissance ◀ 250–53, and the grid pattern was popularized in 17th-century America.

The cause of the phenomenal growth of cities from the 19th century onward is fairly straightforward—the ascendancy of industry over agriculture—but the effects of this change in lifestyle were far more complex. The mechanization of agriculture (see pp.290–91) and the abolition of serfdom in Europe left an excess of labor in rural areas, and that labor force flooded into the cities when the Industrial Revolution (see pp.292–95) provided a new form of employment in the shape of factories and workshops.

Many centers of industry developed in cities that had existed for centuries. Others expanded from small villages,



Urban transportation

The need for mass transit capable of dealing with steep hills led to the development of San Francisco's cable car system in 1873. The cable car's popularity resulted from its replacing horse-drawn transport.

or developed as new cities where raw materials were available, or main roads or rail routes converged. Industrial buildings and railroad yards tended to be close to the city's center, with the

workers—who had no transportation—living in cheap housing within walking distance of the factories. In many heavily industrialized cities, a “factory culture” arose, in which the populations of whole streets and even

neighborhoods were connected by their employment at one particular local mill or factory.

Flocking to the cities

This urban expansion was apparent throughout the industrialized world. In 1850, London, Paris, Constantinople (now Istanbul), and St. Petersburg were the only European cities with more

City Living

Humans have lived together in cities since ancient times, but in 1800, urban areas were home to just 3 percent of the world's population. The massive explosion of urbanization that accompanied the Industrial Revolution saw that figure rise to 15 percent in the space of 100 years.

